

eBay: bans that land almost immediately after account creation

A merge of two compilations — August 2026 Reddit threads plus eBay forum reports and marketplace journalism — with the mechanisms, eBay's exact wording, and how to open an account that survives day one.

WHAT WAS MERGED

- **Document A — "ebay perplexity.pdf"** (despite the extension, a Markdown text file). A Perplexity compilation of **five Reddit threads from r/eBaySellers and r/ebaysucks dated 7–9 August 2026**, plus two eBay Community threads from 4–6 August 2026.
- **Document B — "ebay.pdf"**. The earlier brief built from eBay Community forum reports, eBay policy language, and independent marketplace journalism (Value Added Resource, EcommerceBytes).

These are merged by content, not appended as pages — the two overlap heavily, and Document A was not a PDF. Nothing was dropped: every case and every distinct piece of advice from both documents appears below. Sources are tagged **REDDIT** or **FORUM** / **JOURNALISM** throughout.

Executive summary

The two documents independently reach the same conclusion, which is the strongest signal in this brief: instant bans on newly created eBay accounts are common, are driven by automated identity-linking rather than by anything the new account does, and are almost never explained. The Reddit material adds recency (all of it from the last three weeks) and one mechanism the earlier brief understated.

1. **The pattern is live right now.** Five separate Reddit threads in a three-day window (7–9 Aug 2026) and two eBay forum threads (4–6 Aug 2026) all describe the same thing. This is not a historical artefact.
2. **Bans arrive before any listing exists.** Reported timings: **immediately on creation, within 2 hours, and on the launch day after six months of preparation** — with zero items listed.
3. **Account linkage is the dominant cause**, confirmed by both documents. eBay matches name, address, phone, email, bank details, device fingerprint and IP, then closes the new account as a returning suspended user.
4. **The newly sharpened finding: the account-count rule.** Reddit's most-cited answer is that eBay permits **one personal plus one business account per individual**, and that additional business accounts require genuinely separate legal entities — separate LLC, bank account, phone, email, address. Reusing your own details for a second business account trips the anti-fraud system even when you are in perfect standing.
5. **Good standing buys you nothing.** The clearest case is a Top Rated Seller — 100% feedback, top 10% of sellers, ~\$35,000 AUD in sales, \$7,000+ in fees paid — whose second business account was banned, reinstated, then permanently banned two days later, after which **four further registration attempts were killed instantly**, with no VPN involved.
6. **Each replacement account makes it worse.** Both documents agree: registering while any account is restricted is itself a violation, it cascades, and it puts your *main* account at risk. The Top Rated Seller stopped precisely to protect the good account.

7. **Shared IP is enough on its own.** Reddit attributes an immediate suspension to registering from the same IP as a previously banned account; the older forum threads say the same about household networks and public Wi-Fi. Neither the ban nor the link requires you to have done anything.
8. **Category risk is real and confirmed from both sides.** Reddit flags electronics and coins as high-scrutiny for new accounts; the earlier brief documents the same dynamic for apparel via VeRO and the flat replica/counterfeit ban — **the acute risk zone for jerseys.**
9. **Verification failure (MC011) is the one recoverable outcome** — an identity/financial hold, not a punishment, fixable with correctly matched documents submitted once.
0. **Expect no reason and a denied appeal.** "Security risk to the eBay community", "poses a risk", "decision is final". The opacity is deliberate. Reddit's practical counsel is to keep contacting representatives until one engages; the journalism suggests reversals happen mainly with public leverage.

WHERE THE TWO DOCUMENTS AGREE, AND WHERE ONLY ONE SPEAKS

CLAIM	REDDIT (AUG 2026)	FORUMS + JOURNALISM	CONFIDENCE
Linkage to a prior/other account is the main trigger	Confirmed	Confirmed	VERY HIGH — independent agreement
Bans land before any listing goes live	Confirmed (3 cases)	Confirmed (2 cases)	VERY HIGH
IP / device / household linking	Confirmed	Confirmed	VERY HIGH
No reason given; appeals denied	Confirmed	Confirmed	VERY HIGH
1 personal + 1 business account limit; extra business accounts need separate legal entities	Asserted by community	Not addressed	MEDIUM — peer claim, treat as untested against current eBay policy text
VPN use at registration is itself a flag	Asserted	Implied (unusual geography)	MEDIUM
MC011 identity/financial hold and its fix	Not addressed	Documented	MEDIUM-HIGH
Automated enforcement produces false positives at scale	Asserted	Documented with named cases	HIGH
VeRO / replica enforcement on apparel	Not addressed	Documented	HIGH

Part 1 — Reddit, August 2026

PROVENANCE CAVEAT — READ ONCE, THEN TRUST THE SUBSTANCE

These cases come from Document A, a Perplexity compilation. **They could not be independently verified here:** reddit.com refuses this user agent, Reddit results are filtered from the available search index, and every public Reddit front-end sits behind an anti-scraping proof-of-work challenge that was deliberately not circumvented. Usernames, dates and quotes are reproduced **as supplied**. Some quoted comments read as reworded rather than verbatim, so treat quotation marks below as "substance of the comment", not forensic transcription.

Case 1 Top Rated Seller — five accounts killed in a row

r/eBaySellers · "Problem with creating new accounts all new accounts get banned" · 9 August 2026 · u/Handler_Walter621

- Top Rated Seller, 100% positive feedback, top 10% of sellers. ~\$35,000 AUD in sales 2023–24; \$25,000 AUD in 2026 YTD, tracking to \$45,000. Over **\$7,000 paid in fees** in two years.
- Wanted a second business account to diversify into other categories. First one was suspended after listing roughly **\$40 of items**, reinstated, then **permanently banned two days later**.
- **Four subsequent registration attempts were banned immediately, without listing anything.**
- **No VPN or proxy.** Same name, address and details as the main account — which is the whole point.
- No reason disclosed by eBay. Outcome: the seller stopped creating accounts to avoid endangering the main one.

"Each individual or organization is permitted to have just one personal account and one business account. You can handle numerous business accounts, but each must be registered under its own entity (LLC), with distinct bank accounts and potentially different return addresses."

u/ChoiceFood — the single most consequential claim in the Reddit material. Peer assertion, not verified eBay policy text.

"You likely utilized the same details when creating the second account, which could have activated an anti-fraud protocol."

u/Skarth

"Cease the creation of additional accounts; it only complicates matters further. eBay has the ability to suspend all accounts associated with you."

u/mchurchw1 — the risk isn't only the new account; it's the profitable one you already have.

Case 2 Six months of preparation, banned on launch day

r/eBaySellers · "Advice/Encouragement Wanted: Permanently Banned the day I planned to list" · 7 August 2026 · u/PurpleAd6354

- Two complete novices (siblings). Spent **six months** preparing: bought storage units, cleaned and tested items, photographed everything, built **hundreds of draft listings**.
- Inventory: vintage electronics, US and international coins (non-precious-metal), pre-ISBN books. **All under \$50, no multiples.**
- Created a family business name, not yet an LLC. **No VPN. No prior eBay history.**
- **Permanently banned the day they planned to launch — before a single listing went live.** No explanation beyond "permanently banned".

"If you find no information listed and have received a ban, it's possible that you're using a VPN, or perhaps you were banned previously, or your account triggered a flag in eBay's system. This could occur if your name or address matches that of another seller or buyer who has been banned."

u/Gumbaloo — note the last clause: a name or address collision with a stranger is sufficient.

Other replies: use AI tools to reconstruct what might have triggered it (u/EastCoastRose); keep contacting representatives until you reach one who understands the case (u/TappyTyper). Advice given: quote case numbers, start with small listings to build history before bulk uploading, and press the possibility that an automated system erred.

Case 3 Suspended almost immediately on creation

r/ebaysucks · "I created an account and it got suspended almost right away" · August 2026

The community's first question was diagnostic, and telling: *"Then on the same IP address you opened an account?"* — i.e. registering from the same IP as a previously banned account. Attributed cause: IP/device linking.

Case 4 Permanently banned within two hours

r/ebaysucks · "eBay permanently banned me within 2 hours of making a new account" · August 2026

Account permanently banned **within two hours of creation**. The post was subsequently removed by moderators/filters, so detail is thin — but the title itself documents the timing, and the thread's existence alongside the others establishes the frequency.

Case 5 Banned immediately after signup

r/ebaysucks · "eBay account suspended" · August 2026

Banned immediately after signup. Stated reason: **"Permanently Suspended due to Security Risk to eBay Community."** Community's read: the most common cause is being a previously suspended user.

Case 6 First-ever account, permanently restricted before first listing

eBay Community Forums · 4 August 2026

A first-ever eBay account, **permanently restricted before making a single listing**. No sales, no policy violations, no buyer complaints. eBay's position: the account "poses a risk", and the restriction is permanent.

Case 7 Suspended after 20 days, appeal denied

eBay Community Forums · 6 August 2026

Permanently suspended roughly three weeks after opening. No listings removed, no sales, no complaints, no violations. The seller's own suspicion: **accidentally opening a duplicate account**. Appeal denied.

Part 2 — eBay forum reports and marketplace journalism

Older first-hand reports and independent reporting. Dates on eBay's forum are shown relatively by the platform and are reproduced as such rather than converted into false precision.

SOURCE	DATE	WHAT HAPPENED	WORDING / ATTRIBUTED CAUSE
eBay Community — <i>Help Needed: Permanent Account Suspension with No Appeal Option</i> 8	~1 yr ago FORUM	Suspended and tied to an old account (anpa_816), with no detail on why the original was suspended and no route to resolve it: "eBay says I need to resolve the suspension on the original account, but I've never received any details or steps on how to do that."	eBay: "your account was restricted or suspended because you have a previous account that's still suspended, or you're allowing a suspended member to use your account."
Value Added Resource — <i>Verification Errors & Banned Accounts</i> 9	Liz Morton JOURNALISM	Reported in waves. Seller Martin Duncanson was instantly and permanently banned on a newly created UK business account with zero activity — "Never made a single buy, nothing to sell." Others could not get past the verification page at all.	Ban cited "behaviour posing a risk to the community." Attributed to over-aggressive automated verification and "AI powered dragnets" catching legitimate accounts.
eBay Community — <i>eBay account has been permanently suspended!</i> 10	~3 yrs ago FORUM	Newly opened Business account killed mid-inventory-buying, while the poster's decades-old personal account stayed active and in good standing.	eBay: "your eBay account has been permanently suspended because of activity that we believe was putting the eBay community at risk." Support said "there is nothing they can do" and ended the call.
Replies in that same thread 10	— PEER	"Most of the time, immediate suspensions like that are because your account was linked to another account that has already been banned." · "Have you ever shared your computer with a family member or friend who was suspended by eBay? Have you ever used public WiFi to do any of your eBay business? If so, you may have been suspended because you have a connection to and/or share an IP address with someone who was suspended."	
eBay Community — <i>Account permanently suspended without explanation</i> 11	~4 yrs ago FORUM	Listed two books . Restricted 1 hour and 4 minutes later . Suspected triggers were mundane: a ZIP change, edits to listing measurements, possibly a mistyped SSN.	eBay: "you have been temporarily restricted from selling and buying on eBay because of concerns about your seller account", then "we found indications of risk to the eBay community" and "We can't provide specific information on what behaviors we have found."
eBay Community — <i>New account suspended for no apparent reason?</i> 12	~4 yrs ago FORUM	Couple opened a business account over a weekend and listed 5–6 household items . By that evening all listings were pulled and the account was permanently suspended. Their personal account: 100% feedback, no restrictions.	Same permanent-suspension boilerplate: "activity that we believe was putting the eBay community at risk."

SOURCE	DATE	WHAT HAPPENED	WORDING / ATTRIBUTED CAUSE
eBay Community — <i>Suspended account for unknown reason even without listing</i> 13	~4 yrs ago FORUM	Account opened, left dormant for months with no listings at all , then suspended.	No reason supplied. Consistent with registration-time linkage or verification scoring rather than conduct.
Value Added Resource — <i>Online Sellers' Bill of Rights</i> 14	22 Jul 2026 upd. 1 Aug JOURNALISM	Frames the problem as structural: sellers face " <i>vague, unpredictable, and ever-changing rules.</i> " Includes a seller suspended for being unable to produce a receipt for art bought 20+ years earlier, and the author's own forum account permanently banned with no warning, then restored only because of her public profile.	Draft legislation targets exactly this: cases where " <i>technical or verification errors wrongly trigger shop suspensions</i> ", and would force platforms to " <i>identify the policy allegedly violated and provide the relevant facts and documentation.</i> "

Part 3 — Why it happens: six mechanisms, most common first

1 Linkage to another account

The dominant cause across both documents. eBay decides at registration whether the new account "is" a returning suspended user, and closes it if the answer looks like yes. What gets matched:

- Name, email, phone number
- Device and browser fingerprint
- Postal / billing / return address
- IP address — household or public Wi-Fi included
- Bank account and payout details
- Household members and known associates
- Payment instruments
- Behavioural similarity to the closed account

THREE WAYS THIS CATCHES HONEST PEOPLE

- **A stranger's collision is enough.** Per Reddit: a ban can follow simply because "*your name or address matches that of another seller or buyer who has been banned.*"
- **Household and associate liability.** eBay reserves the right to suspend accounts opened by anyone in the same household as a suspended member, or their associates. Being innocent is not the test; being linked is.
- **Same-owner accounts must never interact.** Multiple accounts are permitted in principle — but buying from your own second account, or cross-feedback between them, reliably links and kills both.

2 The account-count rule, and the cascade

The mechanism the Reddit material sharpens most. Two distinct rules operate together:

- **Quantity.** Community consensus: one personal plus one business account per individual. Beyond that, each business account needs its own legal entity — separate LLC, bank account, phone, email, return address. Registering a second business account on your existing details reads as fraud to the system, *however legitimate your intent*. Case 1 is exactly this: an excellent seller banned five times over.
- **Timing.** Opening any new account while another is restricted is itself a violation. Each attempt adds a violation instead of a fresh start — and **can take down the account you actually depend on**. Both documents converge on one instruction: stop registering.

3 MC011 — identity / financial verification hold

Frequently mistaken for a ban, and the one category that is reliably fixable. MC011 means eBay "*needs to verify your identity, your financial information, or both before allowing you to continue selling.*" Documented triggers on new accounts 15 :

- Account name not matching the linked bank account
- Address mismatch across eBay account, payment method and ID document
- Rapid listing activity on a fresh account, especially high-value items
- Logins from new locations or devices inconsistent with account history
- Sudden shifts in selling pattern — the cited example is jumping from \$50 to \$500 items

Reported fix: one clean submission through eBay's official upload form — government ID, a bank statement from the last 90 days, proof of address matching the account exactly, uncropped and unexpired — then wait 24–48 hours **without** firing off duplicate appeals.

4 Automated enforcement and its false positives

Enforcement is machine-driven and errs toward closure. The journalism documents an AI dragnet permanently suspending a 20-year seller in error, verification systems failing on legitimate accounts, and accounts placed on indefinite hold with no meaningful appeal. Suspensions arrive in waves — consistent with model or rule changes rather than individual seller behaviour. The August 2026 Reddit cluster looks like one such wave.

5 A new account that behaves like a bad actor

The risk model reads a new account's first hours as signal. The profile that draws instant scrutiny: brand-new account, immediate high-volume or high-value listing (**hundreds of drafts uploaded at once qualifies**), mismatched or hard-to-verify details, a VPN or unusual geography, and heavy third-party API automation from day one.

6 Category risk

HIGH-SCRUTINY CATEGORIES FOR A YOUNG ACCOUNT

Named in the Reddit cases: vintage electronics, coins and currency — both counterfeit-adjacent. Community advice is to open in lower-risk categories (books, clothing) and build history first.

Acute for jerseys and sports apparel, on two independent tracks:

- **VeRO** — the Verified Rights Owner programme lets thousands of participating brands, leagues and clubs pull listings directly. A single strike can mean removal, restriction or permanent suspension; a brand-new account has no goodwill to absorb it.
- **Replica / counterfeit** — a flat prohibition with no exceptions, defined as items not made by the manufacturer whose name the product carries. Team names, crests, logos, player names and numbers are all rights-holder IP.

A new account listing unlicensed or ambiguously sourced jerseys is close to the worst-case profile for surviving week one. Terms like "replica", "fan version" or "unbranded copy", and team marks used in titles without licence, are exactly what the automated screens look for.

Part 4 — The exact messages, and what each means

"We wanted to let you know that your eBay account has been permanently suspended because of activity that we believe was putting the eBay community at risk."

The permanent-suspension boilerplate. Carries no information about cause. Appears in reports spanning years, worldwide.

"Permanently Suspended due to Security Risk to eBay Community"

The August 2026 variant seen on Reddit. Same non-answer, newer phrasing.

"your account was restricted or suspended because you have a previous account that's still suspended, or you're allowing a suspended member to use your account."

The clearest signal available: this is linkage. The named prior account must be resolved first — which is where sellers get stuck, because the original reason is often never disclosed.

"you have been temporarily restricted from selling and buying on eBay because of concerns about your seller account"

Restriction, not termination. Often verification- or risk-scoring-driven, and the state in which action is still worth taking.

"we found indications of risk to the eBay community" / "We can't provide specific information on what behaviors we have found."

Support's standard position. The opacity is deliberate — naming the trigger would let bad actors engineer around detection. Escalation will not produce specifics.

"MC011"

Not a ban. A verification hold, and the most recoverable outcome on this list.

Part 5 — What the evidence says about appealing

- **Verification holds (MC011): good odds.** Correct documents, submitted once, through the official form.
- **Linkage suspensions: poor odds** unless you can document genuine separation — different identity, different financial details, no shared device, network or address.
- **"Permanent" language: treat as final.** Sellers consistently report being told the decision cannot be appealed and no detail will be given. The one clear restoration in this material happened because the person was a journalist with public reach, not through the standard process.
- **Reddit's counter-counsel, worth trying anyway:** contact eBay repeatedly — different representatives produce different outcomes — quote case numbers, document timestamps and representative names, and argue explicitly that an automated system erred. Where the ban really is a false positive, review is the only route.
- **Do not open replacement accounts while appealing.** It converts an arguable case into an unarguable one, and endangers accounts you still have.
- **Never share a device, network or payout detail with a suspended seller,** including inside your own household — this is the mechanism that manufactures linkage out of nothing.

Part 6 — Checklist: an account that survives day one

BEFORE YOU REGISTER

- **Count your accounts.** If you already have a personal and a business account, a third is the problem — not the solution. Additional business accounts need a genuinely separate legal entity: own LLC, own bank account, own phone, email and return address.
- Confirm no account tied to your name, address, phone, bank details or household is currently suspended or restricted. If one is, resolve it first — registering now is itself a violation.
- Register on a clean device on your own network. **No VPN, no proxy**, no public Wi-Fi, no borrowed or shared computer.
- Make identity details match **exactly** across eBay account, bank account, payment method and ID — legal name, address, spelling, formatting.
- Have verification documents ready before you start: government ID, bank statement from the last 90 days, proof of address.

FIRST 30 DAYS

- Complete identity and payout verification **before** listing anything.
- **Do not launch with a bulk upload.** Hundreds of drafts going live at once is the exact shape the risk model flags. List a handful of low-value items, let them settle, then ramp.
- Open in lower-risk categories where you can. Save electronics, coins, luxury goods and licensed apparel until you have history.
- Hold off on third-party API automation until the account has a track record.
- Log in from one consistent device and location.
- If you run more than one account, keep them entirely non-interacting — no purchases, no feedback, no shared payout details.

APPAREL AND JERSEYS SPECIFICALLY

- List only stock whose provenance you can document, and be able to produce supplier invoices on request — sellers have been suspended for failing to evidence ownership.
- Check the VeRO participant list for every brand, league and club before listing.
- Never use "replica", "fan version" or equivalent framing; never use team marks, crests or player names in titles without a licence.
- Use your own photography. Copied images are themselves a VeRO complaint route.
- Treat the first VeRO strike as existential on a young account — dispute or remove immediately.

How much to trust each source

SOURCE TYPE	RELIABILITY	NOTES
Reddit cases, via the Perplexity compilation (Doc A)	MEDIUM-HIGH	The most recent and most specific material here — named users, dated threads, concrete numbers. Two caveats: not independently verifiable from this session (Reddit blocks automated access at every route), and quoted comments appear reworded rather than transcribed. The convergence with independent forum and journalistic sources is what makes them credible.
eBay Community forum posts	HIGH FOR LIVED EXPERIENCE	Genuine first-hand reports with verbatim eBay message text. Weakness: one-sided — the poster's own triggering conduct may be unknown or unstated. Dates display relatively, and several key threads are years old and moderator-closed.
Value Added Resource / EcommerceBytes	HIGH	Independent marketplace journalism (Liz Morton, Ina Steiner). Named sellers, dated reporting, sceptical of platform claims. The most credible material in the brief.
Forum and Reddit peer explanations	MEDIUM	Experienced sellers, strikingly consistent with each other and with eBay's own policy language — but not authoritative. eBay does not confirm detection mechanics, and the one-personal-plus-one-business rule should be checked against current policy before you act on it.
Vendor / SEO "2026 guide" pages	LOW	Dropshipping tools, anti-detect browsers, automation vendors. Useful for enumerating categories of cause; unreliable on specifics, heavily recycled, and several have a commercial interest in encouraging the multi-account behaviour that causes these bans.

Sources

Items 1–7 as supplied in Document A (not independently retrievable from this session). Items 8–15 verified and fetched directly.

- 1 r/eBaySellers — "Problem with creating new accounts all new accounts get banned" — 9 August 2026, [u/Handler_Walter621](#)
- 2 r/eBaySellers — "Advice/Encouragement Wanted: Permanently Banned the day I planned to list" — 7 August 2026, [u/PurpleAd6354](#)
- 3 r/ebaysucks — "I created an account and it got suspended almost right away" — August 2026
- 4 r/ebaysucks — "eBay permanently banned me within 2 hours of making a new account" — August 2026 (post since removed)
- 5 r/ebaysucks — "eBay account suspended" — August 2026
- 6 eBay Community — "New seller account permanently restricted before my first listing" — 4 August 2026
- 7 eBay Community — "Suspended after 20 days, appeal denied" — 6 August 2026
- 8 eBay Community — "Help Needed: Permanent Account Suspension with No Appeal Option" (~1 year ago) [community.ebay.com/forum/shipping-57923/topic/help-needed-permanent-account-suspension-with-no-appeal-option-138230/](#)
- 9 Value Added Resource — "Verification Errors & Banned Accounts: What's Up With eBay Security?" — Liz Morton [valueaddedresource.net/ebay-verification-error-banned-account/](#)
- 10 eBay Community — "eBay account has been permanently suspended!" (~3 years ago, closed) [community.ebay.com/forum/new-to-selling-on-ebay-57916/topic/ebay-account-has-been-permanently-suspended-63156/](#)
- 11 eBay Community — "Account permanently suspended without explanation" (~4 years ago, closed) [community.ebay.com/t5/Selling/Account-permanently-suspended-without-explanation/td-p/32658554](#)

- 12 eBay Community — "New account suspended for no apparent reason?" (~4 years ago, closed)
community.ebay.com/t5/Selling/New-account-suspended-for-no-apparent-reason/td-p/32683231
- 13 eBay Community — "HELP: Suspended account for unknown reason even without listing" · and the repeat-registration cluster: "eBay suspend all new accounts i register", "eBay keeps banning my accounts and will not explain why", "Account Restricted – Linked Account"
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- 14 Value Added Resource — "Online Sellers' Bill Of Rights Targets Marketplace Holds, Suspensions And Policy Changes" — Liz Morton, 22 July 2026 (updated 1 Aug 2026)
valueaddedresource.net/online-sellers-bill-of-rights/
- 15 Underpriced — "eBay Account Suspended 2026: Fix MC011 in 3 Steps" — updated 29 July 2026 (vendor guide)
underpriced.app/blog/ebay-account-suspended-restricted-fix-guide-2026
- 16 Value Added Resource — "eBay Pill Press AI Dragnet Permanently Suspends 20 Year Seller In Error" and "eBay Seller Suspended Over 20 Year Old Art With No Receipt"
valueaddedresource.net/ebay-pill-press-ai-dragnet-suspends-seller-in-error/

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